

Sessions

'Sessions' is a cool feature of Requests. It allows you to persist authentication data and cookies across requests. You can create a Session by using the following commands:

```
>>> s = requests.Session()
>>> s.auth = HTTPDigestAuth("user", "pass")
>>> s.headers.update({"X-Deliver-Pizza-To": "Home"})
>>> s.max_redirects = 500
```

Now, instead of using `requests.get()`, `requests.post()` and the rest, you use the methods offered by the Session object, like `s.get()`, `s.post()` and so on, as shown below:

```
>>> s.get("http://example.com/my_digest_endpoint")
```

You can add or remove headers from the Session, as follows:

```
>>> s.get("http://example.com/my_digest_endpoint", headers =
{"X-Deliver-Pizza-To": None, "X-Add-Chicken-Chunks": "Yes"})
```

This will remove the *X-Deliver-Pizza-To* header and add an *X-Add-Chicken-Chunks* header. To remove a header, just set its value to *None*. To override the header, give it a new value. It's that easy.

Sessions are pretty useful. Many authentication libraries that deal in authentication (*requests-oauthlib* for one) don't

return authentication plug-ins, but ask for your credentials and return a Requests session pre-populated with the authentication data. This makes things much easier, both for the library programmer and the user.

Next

This should be enough to get you started with Requests. There is a lot more that Requests can do, and reading the official documentation should help you familiarise yourself with that. You should go ahead and read the documentation for *requests-oauthlib* too, since OAuth is what most REST APIs use nowadays.

Writing custom authentication libraries for Requests is a breeze, so if you want to hack on Requests, this is a good place to start. Requests' transport layer (the bit that handles the actual traffic over the Internet) is built on *urllib3*, but it is modular and can be replaced. The author of Requests specifically wants a non-blocking backend to Requests; so if you're up for it, you can start hacking on that too.

So let me go off and make something awesome with Requests. Till the next time, readers!  END

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